

Municipal Complaint Resolution Policy

Document Type: Policy Framework for Civic Grievance Redressal and Service Recovery.

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

1.1.1 This Policy establishes the principles, process, timelines, accountability standards, and escalation framework for handling complaints received by the municipal administration.

1.1.2 The Policy is intended to ensure timely acknowledgment, fair examination, reasoned resolution, and transparent communication with complainants.

1.2 Scope

1.2.1 This Policy applies to all complaints relating to municipal services, infrastructure, and public utilities under the jurisdiction of the municipal authority.

1.2.2 The Policy shall be read as an internal operational framework and a citizen-facing service standard for complaint handling.

[ulbdataportal](<https://ulbdataportal.in/uploads/F18.pdf>)

2. General Principles

2.1 Service Commitment

2.1.1 Every complaint shall be registered, assigned, tracked, and disposed of in a manner that is prompt, impartial, and documented.

2.1.2 The municipal authority shall ensure that complaints are not closed without adequate review, field verification where required, and communication of the outcome to the complainant.

2.2 Citizen-Centric Approach

2.2.1 The complaint resolution system shall operate on accessibility, simplicity, multilingual support where feasible, and non-discrimination.

2.2.2 The administration shall treat urgent public safety matters as priority cases and shall adopt temporary mitigation measures where immediate final resolution is not possible.

[municipaladm.gov]

(http://www.municipaladm.gov.in/sites/municipaladm.gov.in/files/pdf/Traing_Modules/PGR%20TRAINING%20MATERIAL1.pdf)

3. Types of Complaints Covered

3.1 Core Categories

3.1.1 The Policy covers complaints concerning water supply, electricity-related municipal services, sanitation, drainage, storm water, roads, streetlighting, encroachment, pest control, public cleanliness, and civic infrastructure.

[portal.mcgm.gov](https://portal.mcgm.gov.in/irj/portal/anonymous?NavigationTarget=navurl%3A%2F%2F292767acb759a47eeb3b07911ad27c98&guest_user=english)

3.1.2 The Policy shall also apply to related service issues such as meter-related field inspection requests, damaged public assets, blocked drains, and missed waste collection.

3.2 Illustrative Examples

3.2.1 Example complaints include low water pressure, unscheduled power disruptions in municipal assets, garbage overflow, potholes, broken manholes, and unclean public spaces.

3.2.2 Complaints relating to fees, permits, and general civic service delays may also be accepted if they fall within the functions of the municipal authority.

[portal.mcgm.gov](https://portal.mcgm.gov.in/irj/portal/anonymous?NavigationTarget=navurl%3A%2F%2F292767acb759a47eeb3b07911ad27c98&guest_user=english)

4. Complaint Registration

4.1 Filing Methods

4.1.1 Complaints may be lodged through the municipal online portal, citizen facilitation centers, designated telephone numbers, or any other channel notified by the authority.

[portal.mcgm.gov](https://portal.mcgm.gov.in/irj/portal/anonymous?NavigationTarget=navurl%3A%2F%2F292767acb759a47eeb3b07911ad27c98&guest_user=english)

4.1.2 The complainant shall be issued a complaint number or tracking reference upon successful registration.

4.2 Minimum Information Required

4.2.1 The complaint submission shall include the complainant's name, contact details, location of issue, nature of grievance, and supporting material where available.

4.2.2 Photographs, references, and specific landmarks may be requested to assist verification and route allocation.

[youtube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ve4zZsQOFRk)

5. Step-by-Step Complaint Filing Process

5.1 Intake

5.1.1 The citizen shall select the relevant complaint category and submit the issue through the approved channel.

5.1.2 The system or receiving office shall capture the complaint and generate an acknowledgement.

5.2 Validation

5.2.1 The complaint shall be screened for completeness, urgency, and departmental routing.

5.2.2 If the complaint is incomplete, the complainant may be asked to provide clarifications or additional evidence.

[udma.wb.gov](https://udma.wb.gov.in/page/cms/grievance_procedure_321019)

5.3 Assignment

5.3.1 Valid complaints shall be assigned to the competent officer or field unit without undue delay.

5.3.2 The assigned officer shall record the complaint in the departmental log and initiate action.

[municipaladmn.gov]

(http://www.municipaladmn.gov.in/sites/municipaladmn.gov.in/files/pdf/Traing_Modules/PGR%20TRAINING%20MATERIAL1.pdf)

6. Response Timelines

6.1 Acknowledgment

6.1.1 The complainant shall receive acknowledgment within the time prescribed by the municipality's service standards.

6.1.2 Where digital systems are used, acknowledgment shall ordinarily be generated automatically after submission.

[westelgin](<https://www.westelgin.net/en/living-here/resources/Documents/Complaint-Policy.pdf>)

6.2 Resolution and Update

6.2.1 The designated officer shall review the grievance, initiate field inspection if required, and provide a resolution report or status update within the prescribed working days.

[ulbdataportal](<https://ulbdataportal.in/uploads/F18.pdf>)

6.2.2 If immediate final resolution is not feasible, the complainant shall be informed of the estimated completion timeline and interim measures.

7. Escalation Matrix

7.1 First Level

7.1.1 Complaints shall first be handled by the designated operational officer responsible for the subject matter and geographical jurisdiction.

7.1.2 The first-level officer shall either resolve the matter or provide a reasoned report for escalation.

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7.2 Second and Higher Levels

7.2.1 If the complaint remains unresolved within the defined timeline, it shall escalate automatically or administratively to the next competent authority.

7.2.2 Each escalation level shall include review of the prior action taken, pending issues, and corrective directions.

[udma.wb.gov](https://udma.wb.gov.in/page/cms/grievance_procedure_321019)

8. Roles and Responsibilities

8.1 Municipal Officers

8.1.1 Officers shall ensure timely logging, verification, inspection, remedy, and closure of complaints assigned to them.

8.1.2 Supervisory officers shall monitor pending complaints and ensure that subordinate staff comply with the prescribed timelines.

[lsgkerala.gov](<http://lsgkerala.gov.in/index.php/en/public-grievance-redressal-mechanism>)

8.2 Department Heads

8.2.1 Department heads shall review complaint trends, remove systemic bottlenecks, and direct resources to recurring problem areas.

8.2.2 They shall also certify the accuracy of closure reports and service recovery actions where necessary.

[lsgkerala.gov](<http://lsgkerala.gov.in/index.php/en/public-grievance-redressal-mechanism>)

9. Citizen Rights During Resolution

9.1 Right to Information

9.1.1 The complainant shall have the right to know the complaint number, responsible department, status, and expected timeline.

9.1.2 Reasons for delay or closure shall be communicated in plain language.

[westelgin](<https://www.westelgin.net/en/living-here/resources/Documents/Complaint-Policy.pdf>)

9.2 Right to Fair Treatment

9.2.1 The complainant shall be treated respectfully and shall not be denied service on arbitrary or discriminatory grounds.

9.2.2 The administration shall provide a channel for review where the complainant is dissatisfied with the initial resolution.

[ulbdataportal](<https://ulbdataportal.in/uploads/F18.pdf>)

10. Transparency and Accountability

10.1 Record Keeping

10.1.1 All complaints, actions, inspections, and resolutions shall be recorded in the official complaint management system.

10.1.2 Records shall be retained for audit, review, and public accountability purposes.

10.2 Reporting

10.2.1 Departments shall publish periodic summaries showing complaint volumes, disposal rates, and pendency status.

10.2.2 Complaint trends shall be reviewed to identify chronic service failures and preventive actions.

[municipaladm.gov]

(http://www.municipaladm.gov.in/sites/municipaladm.gov.in/files/pdf/Traing_Modules/PGR%20TRAINING%20MATERIAL1.pdf)

11. Quality of Resolution

11.1 Closure Standards

11.1.1 A complaint shall be considered closed only after the corrective action is completed, verified, and communicated to the complainant.

11.1.2 Where permanent repair is not possible immediately, a temporary measure may be recorded, but the complaint shall remain open until final remedy is completed.

[ulbdataportal](<https://ulbdataportal.in/uploads/F18.pdf>)

11.2 Verification

11.2.1 Field verification, photographic evidence, and supervisor review may be used to confirm closure.

11.2.2 The complainant's feedback may be obtained before final closure in cases involving complex works or recurring faults.

12. Complaint Records and Data Handling

12.1 Data Integrity

12.1.1 Complaint records shall be maintained accurately, with time stamps, routing history, action notes, and status changes preserved.

12.1.2 Unauthorized alteration of records shall be prohibited and treated as a disciplinary matter.

12.2 Confidentiality

12.2.1 Personal information shall be used only for complaint processing and lawful administrative purposes.

12.2.2 Sensitive information shall be protected to the extent permitted by applicable policy and law.

13. Monitoring and Review

13.1 Internal Monitoring

13.1.1 The municipality shall periodically review complaint data to identify delays, recurring defects, and underperforming service areas.

13.1.2 Supervisory review meetings shall be conducted to correct systemic issues and improve response quality.

[lsgkerala.gov](<http://lsgkerala.gov.in/index.php/en/public-grievance-redressal-mechanism>)

13.2 Policy Review

13.2.1 This Policy shall be reviewed at defined intervals to reflect operational experience, legal changes, and citizen feedback.

13.2.2 Amendments shall be issued through competent authority approval and notified appropriately.

14. Exceptions and Special Cases

14.1 Emergency Matters

14.1.1 Complaints involving immediate danger to life, public health, or essential infrastructure shall receive priority handling.

14.1.2 The municipality may deploy emergency field teams, traffic control, or temporary service interruption measures where required.

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14.2 Duplicate and Malicious Complaints

14.2.1 Duplicate complaints may be linked for tracking, but service action shall still be ensured where the issue remains unresolved.

14.2.2 Malicious or knowingly false complaints may be handled under applicable administrative procedures.

15. Closing Provisions

15.1 Binding Nature

15.1.1 All municipal officers shall comply with the procedures and service timelines prescribed under this Policy.

15.1.2 Once the complaint is resolved and communicated, the matter shall be treated as concluded unless reopened through a valid review or escalation request.

[ulbdataportal](<https://ulbdataportal.in/uploads/F18.pdf>)

15.2 Effective Administration

15.2.1 The Policy shall take effect from the date notified by the municipal authority.

15.2.2 The administration shall ensure training, public dissemination, and system readiness to support implementation.